



101 CE

ROMAN EMPEROR TRAJAN CONQUERS DACIA

Trajan undertook two campaigns (101–102 CE and 105–106 CE) to extend Roman borders beyond the Danube by invading the Dacian kingdom (in modern Romania) of Decebalus. After an initial truce, the legions returned and razed the Dacian capital Sarmizegetusa, capturing Decebalus and reducing Dacia to a Roman province.

◀ Second Dacian campaign, detail of Trajan's column relief



76–138 CE

EMPEROR HADRIAN

The adoptive son of Trajan, Hadrian reversed his predecessor's expansionist policy. He consolidated the imperial frontiers, built Hadrian's Wall, and conducted extensive tours of the empire.

c. 130 CE **Kushan ruler**
Kanishka invades northern
India, conquering as far
south as Mathura

132 CE **Zhang Heng**
demonstrates the first
seismograph to the Han
imperial court

132 CE **The Second
Jewish revolt** against
Roman rule is led by
Simon Bar Kokhba

139 CE



△ Hadrian's Wall, viewed from Hotbank Crags

122 CE

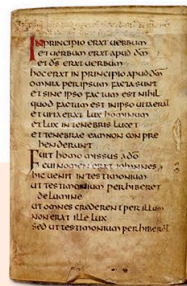
HADRIAN'S WALL BUILT

On a visit to Britain in 122 CE, Emperor Hadrian ordered the erection of a barrier to mark the northern border of the Roman province. When completed, the 5-m (16-ft) high turf and stone wall snaked 80 Roman miles between Wallsend on the River Tyne and the Solway Firth, punctuated by 16 forts and numerous fortlets and turrets for its 9,000-strong garrison.

105–868 CE PAPER AND THE BOOK



105 CE **Chinese official Cai Lun** boils rags and tree bark, drying the pulp to create paper, a durable, economical writing surface.



c. 400 CE **Codices (books)** with stitched-together pages (as *St. Cuthbert Gospel*, above) replace older, unwieldy scrolls.



868 CE **The Diamond Sutra**, a Buddhist devotional tract, is the oldest known book printed, produced using a single wooden block per page.

Paper allowed reading material to be produced far more cheaply than papyrus and vellum previously used in Egypt and Greece.